WNA

WHY NOT ACT

There is a way ...

...where responsibility, opportunity, and fairness align!

WNA
WHY NOT ACT
There is a way ...

Why we should integrate currently law abiding and compliant Undocumented Immigrants into the US citizenship process!

...where responsibility, opportunity, and fairness align!

WNA
WHY NOT ACT
There is a way ...

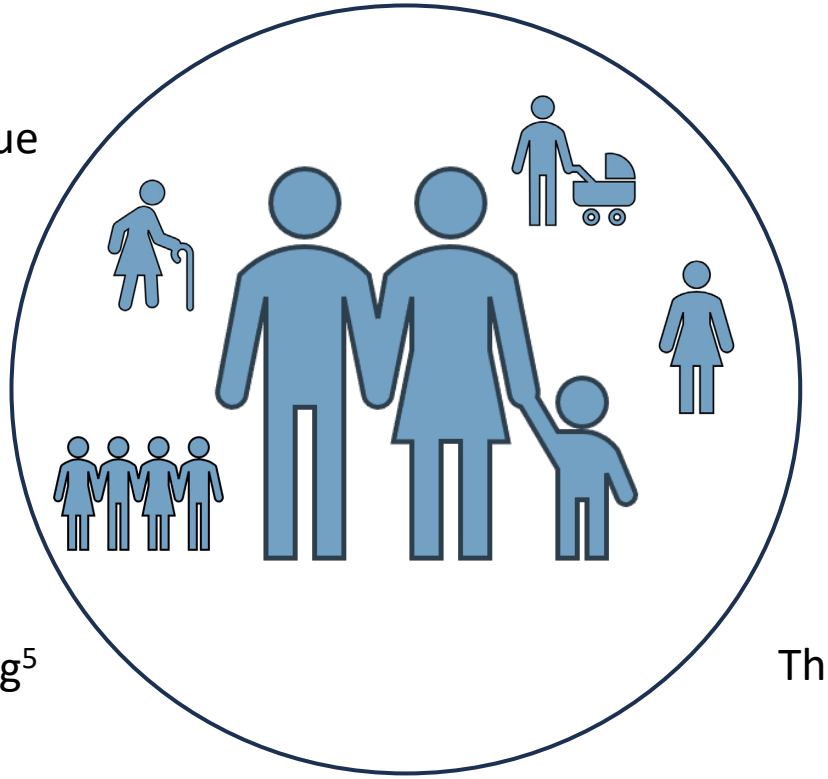
Undocumented Immigrants (UI) in the US

Estimated to be between 11 – 13.7 Million are currently residing here in the US[3]

They own over 815,000 businesses – estimated value is $81.5 Billion[1]

They own an estimated 3.4 million properties = roughly $1.2 Trillion in valuation[2]

The vast majority are working, and except for their status, are law abiding[5]



On average they have been here living in the US over 15-16 years[4]

They hold the US in high regard and desire to remain and strengthen our country

They are largely compliant and productive citizens and take part in US processes whenever and wherever the can

1 – Estimated via multiple business valuation sources. Investopedia, Altline.sobanco.com, bizbuysell.com
2 - NY Post.com article Nov 13, 2024, Itep.org, Nov 2017
3 – Pew Research 2022, USAFacts / DHS 2022, Center for Migration Studies 2023
4 – Pew Research, 2017
5 – Reuters Article July 16, 2024, Wash Post article, Apr 11, 2025

...where responsibility, opportunity, and fairness align!

WNA
WHY NOT ACT
There is a way ...

Undocumented Immigrants (UI) in the US

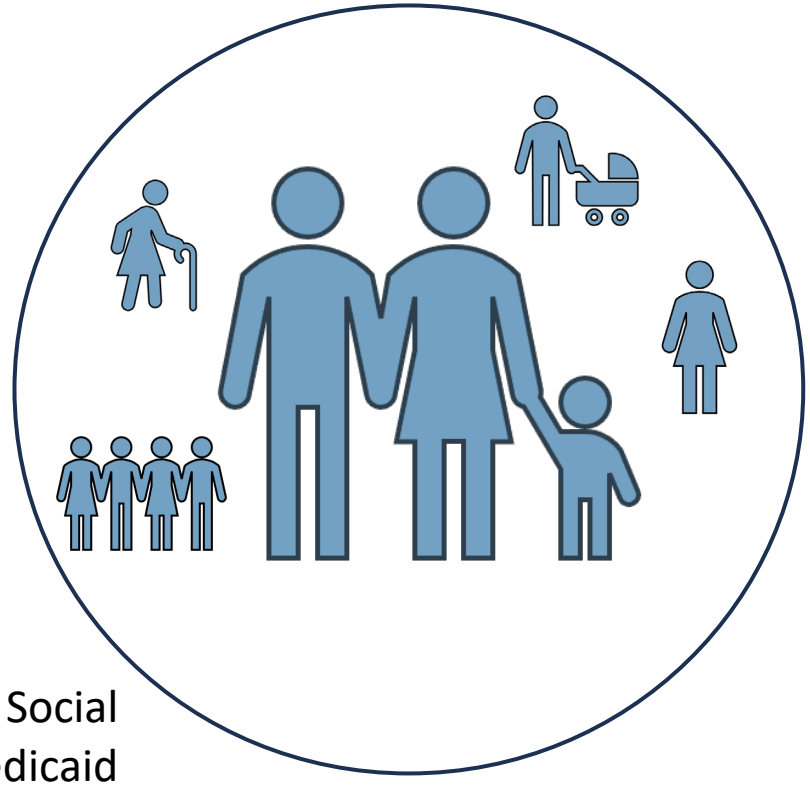
For good or bad almost everyone is two - three degrees of separation away from a UI, whether they know it or not

Most Americans are within 2-3 degrees of separation of a UI

In highly diverse urban cities it is 1-2 degrees away

Which means the odds are very high that we daily interact with a UI or a child's school mate's parent is one

They cannot retire based upon Social Security, Medicare, Medicaid



3.6% of all people in the US are UIs (1 in every 28 people)

Majority pay taxes (and want to) but can never receive a refund

They are exploited at a higher rate because they have no voice and fear the risk of deportation if they do speak up

They do consume services paid for by citizens due to the fact they cannot take part in US processes such as healthcare.

...where responsibility, opportunity, and fairness align!

WNA
WHY NOT ACT
There is a way ...

Immigrants (UI) in the US

The Issue is highly polarizing - but it doesn't have to be!

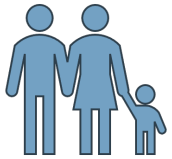
THE POLITICS

Progressive left

- Decriminalization of Immigration
- Abolish or Dismantle ICE
- Sanctuary and Protection for all Immigrants
- Pathway to Citizenship for All Undocumented Immigrants
- Open or Loosely Regulated Borders (in principle)
- Global Justice and Anti-Imperialism
- Racial and Social Justice Framing

Conservative right

- Nationalism and Sovereignty – Immigration should be strictly controlled
- Demographic and Cultural Anxiety
- Security and Crime Concerns
- Economic Protectionism
- Anti-Globalism
- "America First" Ideology



Middle left

- Pathway to Citizenship for Undocumented Immigrants
- Support for DACA and DREAMERS
- Enforcement with Reform
- Legal Immigration is a Strength
- Rejection of Nativism and Xenophobia
- Focus on Practical Solutions

Middle right

- Pro-Immigration Optimism (Assimilationist) – A Nation of Immigrants
- Legalization + Border Enforcement (The IRCA 1986)
- Economic Pragmatism
- Cold War Anti-Communism (those fleeing Communism and Oppression)
- Moral and Religious Framing of the Issue
- Rule of Law, but not Punitive

The path to success is for all parties get something out of an Idea!

...where responsibility, opportunity, and fairness align!

WNA
WHY NOT ACT
There is a way ...

Undocumented Immigrants (UI) in the US

THE IDEA:

- Secure the border – paid for by fine/penalty
- Impose a fine/penalty of $30,000 (or some prorated amount) per person on all current Undocumented Immigrants to gain access into the US Immigration System
- Split the fine/penalty 50% with the States to leverage trust and incentivize process ownership at the local level
- Require all UIs to produce a series of references to prove good standing while in the US
- Open the door to participation in the Military or AmeriCorps as a way to reduce the amount of money required for entry into the Pathway
- Mandatory ESL and normal citizenship training

Pros
- Potential $300 Billion revenue generator
- Avoids mass deportation costs (Estimate $315 – 960 Billion)
- Avoid economic disruptions (tax payment losses, business closures, & housing market)
- Continue to smartly manage the US population into the future
- Avoid “off-shoring” of an enormous amount of accumulated capital
- Shrinks the ICE mission for deportation to criminal activity
- Avoids future civil unrest and focuses efforts on a positive outcome
- Potentially unifying communities

Cons
- Could cause a rush at the border
- May be seen as unequal treatment
- Could increase near term fear of criminal activity
- Will never be agreed to by some

...where responsibility, opportunity, and fairness align!

What does the Progressive Left get out of the "Idea"?

- Decriminalization of Immigration – This provides a way to do this by offering a fine/penalty that moves the UI from being considered a "criminal" to being considered an "applicant" into the US system. It does not guarantee the path but opens the door to it.
- Abolish or Dismantle ICE – This provides a much easier and focused job for ICE to achieve its mission by lowering the number of immigrants to be removed due to unlawful activities. It should also lower the conflict between those that see the ICE mission as disruptive.
- Sanctuary and Protection for all Immigrants – This provides for the Protection for law abiding, compliant and productive UIs currently residing in the US.
- Pathway to Citizenship for All Undocumented Immigrants – Similar to the item above. It does provide a conditions-based pathway for entering the pathway are met.
- Open or Loosely Regulated Borders (in principle) – Possibly from a temporary point of view only
- Global Justice and Anti-Imperialism – While not addressing these directly, this and the next principle do show the world that the US values in its citizens (both current and future).
- Racial and Social Justice Framing – Demonstrates to the world that we see the value of all people groups are able to peacefully recreate Immigration waves of of the 1800s and early 1900s.

WNA
WHY NOT ACT
There is a way ...

What does the Middle Left get out of the "Idea"?

- Pathway to Citizenship for Undocumented Immigrants – This provides for a way to create a repeatable pathway for citizenship for Law Abiding, Compliant, and Productive UIs.
- Support for DACA and DREAMers – Actually supersedes these Acts, keeps families together and doesn't discriminate by the nature of the proposal for a financial penalty / fine as the pathway for all involved.
- Enforcement with Reform – Allows for a way to purchase time for a larger Immigration reform dialogue to occur. Provides a plan to agree on an enforcement payment model for current UIs. Should allow for a better focus by ICE on unlawful UIs.
- Legal Immigration is a Strength – Demonstrates an agreement on this statement and by applying a fine/penalty model this also strengthens the notion that we are a Nation of Immigrants and desire a pathway.
- Rejection of Nativism and Xenophobia – Same as above. Also gives communities the chance to rise up and serve/support UIs they now know and love. Take the same passion that have created the recent demonstrations and focus it on actually getting law abiding, compliant, and productive citizens into the system. This will also form a bridge across the segments of our society.
- Focus on Practical Solutions – Provides a very practical and easy to understand solution. After initial program startup costs each UI is a $30,000 revenue generation transaction. Moves the financial discussion from a **cost center to revenue generator** which can be used for a variety of purposes.

...where responsibility, opportunity, and fairness align!

WNA
WHY NOT ACT
There is a way ...

What does the Middle Right get out of the "Idea"?

- Pro-Immigration Optimism (Assimilationist) – A Nation of Immigrants – This recognizes the value of the UI population to the economic and demographic future of the US while appealing to the need for a fine / penalty model to right a legal wrong.
- Legalization + Border Enforcement (The IRCA 1986) – Allows for an expansion of this Reagan era solution with a more inclusive and up to date version.
- Economic Pragmatism – Creates a revenue generating opportunity for the Nation (roughly $300 Billion) while also keeping Trillions of equity dollars of business and property ownership in the US economy. Keeps the lower skilled economy going (cleaning, serving, agriculture, construction, and trash pickup).
- Cold War Anti-Communism (those fleeing Communism and Oppression) – Shows we have confidence in democratic principles and value system. Some UIs are here because of oppression and economic hardships. Because you have the right to try here in the US you can be successful through hard work.
- Moral and Religious Framing of the Issue – This proposal provides a mechanism to bridge the teachings of all major religious groups to be able see the sojourner / immigrant as an honored guest and potential member of your society
- Rule of Law, but not Punitive – Imposing a fine / penalty of a level that is impactful, but not punitive is a way of applying rule of the law in a compassionate manner while still being fiscally responsible.

WNA
WHY NOT ACT
There is a way ...

What does the Conservative Right get out of the "Idea"?

- Nationalism and Sovereignty – Immigration should be strictly controlled – Provides for a tightening of immigration at the border (and maybe paying for it), creates a pathway for current lawful, compliant and productive UIs so as not to incur an enormous process of capital flight if mass deportation is put into place. By separating the lawful / productive from the unlawful / unproductive, the ICE deportation mission should become easier, less costly, and much smaller.
- Demographic and Cultural Anxiety – By creating a pathway for UIs already residing in the US, the country has the opportunity to shape the minds of those seeking to join through the US process (requiring Civics, ESL, etc…). Also our without immigration our population is shrinking[1].
- Security and Crime Concerns – It would actually bolster security by allowing the process to vet UIs who are already here and self identify, allow for swifter deportation of bad actors, lower crime for those who are preyed upon by actual criminals, and provide hope which will move people away from crime to a realizable future.
- Economic Protectionism – By creating a tax paying base for lower income jobs without fear of reprisal this proposal bolsters the US economy. As mentioned, we must embrace a proposal like this or face a shrinking population and tax base.
- Anti-Globalism – This proposal allows for a greater ability to develop and project economic power by assimilation into the US constitutionally based freedoms. There is no doubt America is Great and the freedoms are why people want to be here.
- "America First" Ideology – And this proposal agrees. We need solidify our future with more resources.

...where responsibility, opportunity, and fairness align!

[1]The US Population is set to shrink by 2033 without immigration
https://www.bloomberg.com/news/articles/2025-03-27/us-population-set-to-shrink-by-2033-if-no-immigration-cbo-says?embedded-checkout=true

WNA
WHY NOT ACT
There is a way ...

Why is this good for the States:

- We propose 50% of collected $30,000 per Undocumented Immigrant (UI) would stay at the State level to pay for local processes and integration of UIs into the local economies. This could result in the following revenue:
  - California $43.6 Billion
  - Texas $29.5 Billion
  - Florida $18.3 Billion
  - New York $12.5 Billion
  - Illinois $8.8 Billion
  - Georgia $7.2 Billion
  - New Jersey $7.1 Billion
  - North Carolina $6.7 Billion
  - Massachusetts $5.8 Billion
  - Maryland $5.6 Billion
  - Virginia $5.4 Billion
  - Washington $5.1 Billion
  - Arizona $4.6 Billion
  - Pennsylvania $3.7 Billion
  - Colorado $3.4 Billion
  - Nevada $2.9 Billion
  - Connecticut $2.9 Billion
  - Tennessee $2.8 Billion

Source: Migration Policy Institute Source: MPI analysis of U.S. Census Bureau 2019-23 ACS and 2023 (along with 2008) SIPP data, weighted to 2023 unauthorized immigrant population estimates provided by Jennifer Van Hook of The Pennsylvania State University. Dollar amounts reflect 50% of $30,000 penalty / fine.

WNA
WHY NOT ACT
There is a way ...

The Take Away:

Solving problems takes belief and pragmatic thinking

- This is a hard issue but there is a solution if we are willing to talk about it!
- We need a plan to create focus on the value of lawful and productive Undocumented Immigrants
- This “idea” meets many of the closely held political ideals for the majority of the US population
- As frustration over inaction and the rate of deportation is leading to growing civil unrest
- We need to compel the community to become a part of the solution

WNA
WHY NOT ACT
There is a way ...

My question:

What would need to be true for this idea to be considered?

WNA
WHY NOT ACT
There is a way ...

Thank you
for you time

Scan for more info

info@whynotact.org

www.WhyNotAct.org

...where responsibility, opportunity, and fairness align!